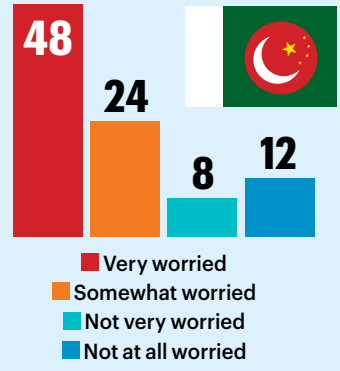
confidence in the Indian economy's innate capacity to absorb the shocks; a mere 8.7 per cent advocated acquiescence to American demands. Trade talks between the two nations remain stalled due to mismatched expectations. The US has long sought greater access to Indian markets in agriculture, dairy and automobiles, while India has been pressing for tariff relief on its labour-intensive exports, particularly textiles and garments. Public opinion appears divided on where blame lies: 53.5 per cent fault the US, 22 per cent point the finger at India, and 16 per cent hold both equally culpable. Despite mounting Western sanctions, India continues to buy discounted Russian oil, citing a steadfast commitment to its domestic economy and consumers. India also notes that it was initially encouraged by the US to procure Russian crude to stabilise volatile global oil prices. Reflecting this stance, 68.7 per cent of respondents believe that continuing to buy oil from Moscow serves India's national interest, while only 15.9 per cent dissent.

The Pak-US Tango

Dominating the foreign policy landscape, though, was Op. Sindoor and the supercharged narratives around it. Even amidst contested details, there's consensus that India massively escalated the cost for Pakistan's policy of 'war by other means'. The 88-hour conflict saw India's military extend its reach to sensitive military assets deep within Pakistan, raising the benchmark for reciprocity. The public mood is in sync. Asked if India should play sports, including cricket, with Pakistan, over 68 per cent of respondents say no; only 24.5 per cent think otherwise. On its part, the government has decided to forgo bilateral series with Pakistan, although Indian teams will continue to face their rivals in multilateral tournaments.

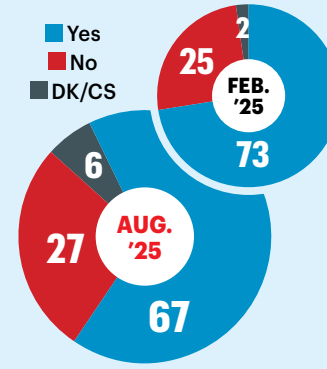
India's diplomatic resolve is being put to test not just by the Trump administration's aggressive tariff policies but also from America's open courting and hosting of Pakistani army chief Asim Munir. Asked how India should respond if the US deepens its political/military support to Pakistan, over 59 per cent advocate bolstering ties with allies such as Russia, while 29 per cent favour enhancing military readiness. Only 5.5 per cent believe in seeking dialogue with

Q. How worried are you about the emerging nexus between China, Pakistan and Bangladesh?



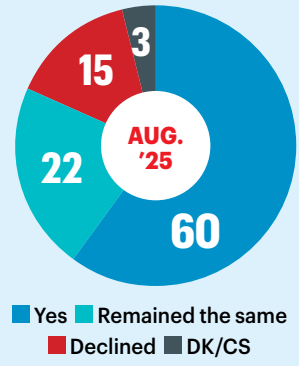
A possible encirclement by inimical forces worries 72 per cent of respondents

Q. Has India's foreign policy under the NDA government strengthened its global standing?



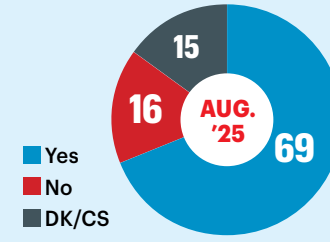
Most people questioned still believe the foreign policy of the NDA is robust

Q. Have India's global influence and reputation improved in recent years?



Over 80 per cent say India's global influence has improved/ stayed the same

Q. India continues to buy discounted Russian oil despite Western sanctions and imposition of high tariffs by US. Is this in India's national interest?



Over two-thirds say India must not yield to US pressure and protect national interest interests

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS: Don't know/can't say

56 PER CENT

upper caste Hindus think close India-China engagement will strengthen India's position globally—highest among caste groups